

Client Onboarding Automation Workflow

Case Study · Post-sale onboarding workflow built using Google Sheets, Zapier, and Gmail

Overview

This project was built to structure the early onboarding phase after a client is confirmed. Instead of relying on memory, scattered communication, or manual checking, the workflow turns onboarding into a trackable process with clear stages, reminder logic, and readiness visibility.

3	14	3
workflow layers	tracked fields	follow-up stages

Problem

After a client is confirmed, onboarding often becomes inconsistent. Welcome communication may be delayed, required details may remain incomplete, and follow-up can easily become dependent on memory or manual checking.

Objective

Create a lightweight onboarding workflow that starts automatically, tracks missing information, manages reminder timing, and moves the client toward kickoff readiness through clear status transitions.

Solution

A multi-step onboarding workflow was built around a structured Google Sheet and connected automations. The system sends the welcome email, tracks incomplete onboarding cases, runs staged reminders, and transitions clients to a kickoff-ready state once required inputs are complete.

Workflow Architecture

Zap 1	Onboarding Start	Recognizes a confirmed client, sends welcome communication, and initializes
Zap 2	Reminder Engine	Runs on a schedule, checks incomplete onboarding rows, and sends staged remind
Zap 3	Kickoff Ready Transition	Moves a client to a kickoff-ready state once required information is complete.

Workflow Flow

- A confirmed client enters the onboarding system.
- The workflow sends a welcome email and initializes onboarding tracking.
- If required details remain incomplete, reminders are triggered in stages.
- Once missing items are cleared, the record transitions toward kickoff readiness.

Core Design and Operational Logic

- Onboarding starts only when the client is clearly marked as confirmed.
- Welcome communication and reminder logic are separated so the workflow stays stable and easier to troubleshoot.
- Status movement is intentional: confirmed, welcome sent, information pending, information received, kickoff ready, and onboarding complete.
- Manual override is available so automation can be paused where human control is needed.

Tracking Structure

The sheet acts as the control layer for the workflow. It tracks the client, service type, onboarding stage, required information, missing items, last contact date, next follow-up date, follow-up count, kickoff status, owner assignment, manual override, and notes. This makes it possible to see not only what has happened, but also what still needs action.

Business Value

- Reduces dependence on memory and scattered follow-up.
- Improves visibility into incomplete onboarding cases.
- Creates a clearer path from client confirmation to kickoff readiness.
- Makes the onboarding process more operational and repeatable.

What It Demonstrates

Workflow automation design	Structuring process stages instead of automating isolated actions.
Operations thinking	Handling follow-up timing, missing information, and readiness movement.
System reliability	Separating responsibilities across layers to reduce confusion and hidden breakage.
Business readability	Designing a workflow that can be explained clearly to non-technical stakeholders.

Outcome

The result was a structured post-sale onboarding workflow that handles welcome communication, missing-information reminders, and kickoff-ready transition with clearer process discipline. It now serves as a proof-of-work project in workflow automation, business operations, and client system design.

Best Uses

- LinkedIn project proof
- Interview portfolio support
- Resume and outreach conversations
- Freelance/operations workflow discussions

Designed to work as a concise proof asset rather than a dense technical document.